



**HIM BUSINESS SCHOOL**  
HOTEL INSTITUTE MONTREUX

COURSE PROPOSAL · 2026 - 27

# CONTEMPORARY HORECA SCENE

Trends · Design & Atmosphere · Neurogastronomy · Technology · World's Best Restaurants & Bars

A 12-week elective that turns the global hospitality scene into a practical business lens — for the next generation of world-ready leaders.

**AUTHOR & COURSE LEADER**

**Egor Tarasenko**

Master in Business Management — Hotel Institute Montreux Alumnus

Montreux · 2026

12 weeks · 36 contact hours · English



# Why this course — and why now

The global scene is moving faster than the curriculum

“The world's best hospitality is being redefined right now — in Lima, Hong Kong, Dubai, Oslo and São Paulo.

This course brings the frontier into the classroom.”

**Nº 1**

**BAR LEONE, HONG KONG**

First Asian bar ever crowned The World's Best Bar (2025)

**Nº 1**

**MAIDO, LIMA**

World's Best Restaurant 2025 — Latin America leads the table

**51**

**COUNTRIES AT WORLD CLASS**

Global bartending finals 2025, Toronto — won by Norway

**\$2M**

**PROJECTED IMPACT**

50 Best week in Lima, Nov 2026 — rankings drive tourism

- Rankings (Michelin, The 50 Best, GreatList) have become industry infrastructure: they move tourism, investment and careers.
- Technology — from AI-generated serves to revenue management — is reshaping operations and creativity at the same time.
- Students need a live map of the industry: this course updates every year with the latest lists, ceremonies and case venues.

# About the author & course architecture

A practical lens on strategy, concept design and venue economics



HIM ALUMNUS · COURSE LEADER

## Egor Tarasenko

Master in Business Management  
Hotel Institute Montreux

- **Graduate of the Master in Business Management programme at Hotel Institute Montreux.**

The course is designed as an alumnus contribution: a bridge between Swiss hospitality management and today's global restaurant and bar scene.

- **Focus: strategy, brand and economics of contemporary restaurants and bars.**

From concept and atmosphere engineering to unit economics and ranking strategy.

- **Built on primary industry sources, refreshed annually.**

MICHELIN Guide ceremonies, The 50 Best rankings and stories, GreatList expert reviews, Diageo World Class programmes.

- **Delivery: lectures + case labs + sensory practice + guest speakers.**

Industry practitioners join live or online; students work with real lists and real venues.

# Course at a glance

One elective — a full tour of the contemporary scene

**12**

**WEEKS**

Semester elective, weeks 1-12 of the term

**36**

**CONTACT HOURS**

12 sessions × 3 hours: lecture + case + lab

**5+1**

**MODULES**

Five thematic modules and a final pitch day

**EN**

**LANGUAGE**

English; key sources and guest speakers

**BBA · MIB**

**AUDIENCE**

Bachelor and master students of hospitality & business

**4**

**ASSESSMENT BLOCKS**

Participation, field notes, module tasks, final pitch

Positioning: a business-perspective tour of the contemporary HoReCa scene — what the world's best venues do, why guests love them, and how rankings, design, science and technology create competitive advantage.

# Learning outcomes

What students will be able to do after 12 weeks

## 01 Navigate the global ranking ecosystem

Michelin, The 50 Best, GreatList, World Class — how they work and how to use them in marketing and strategy.

## 02 Analyse HoReCa trends

Turn macro-trends — experience economy, anti-luxury, mindfulness — into concrete business decisions.

## 03 Design venue concepts

Interior, light, sound, scent and guest journey (CJM) — atmosphere as a managed product.

## 04 Apply culinary science & neurogastronomy

Physics & chemistry of flavour, multisensory design of menus, serves and service: from plate weight to sound pairing.

## 05 Evaluate technology & AI

Reservations, revenue management, kitchen automation, data personalisation — with an ethics filter.

## 06 Pitch at world level

Develop and defend a venue concept benchmarked against the world's best bars and restaurants.

# Course map

Five modules, one arc: from trends to a world-class concept

| # | Module                             | Weeks | Core question                       | Signature cases                                         |
|---|------------------------------------|-------|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Contemporary HoReCa Trends         | 1–3   | Where is the industry heading?      | 50 Best week in Lima; Californios ★★★; Gerbou           |
| 2 | Venue Design & Atmosphere          | 4–5   | What makes a space unforgettable?   | GreatList criteria; Himkok; Hanu Dubai                  |
| 3 | Neurogastronomy & Guest Experience | 6–7   | How do senses shape taste?          | Spence's gastrophysics; World Class multisensory        |
| 4 | Technology & Automation            | 8–9   | What should be human, what — smart? | AI-inspired serve (Don Julio 1942); Sesto Senso Academy |
| 5 | World's Leading Restaurants & Bars | 10–12 | Who sets the global standard?       | Noma; Maido; Bar Leone; Myojaku; Felice Capasso         |
| + | Final Pitch Day                    | 12    | Can your venue win the world stage? | Student concepts judged by an expert panel              |

## MODULE 1 · WEEKS 1-3

# Contemporary HoReCa Trends

Lecture seminars: reading the industry's present and near future

### TOPICS

- Experience economy: dining as theatre — chef's tables, counters, storytelling formats.
- Anti-luxury & casualization: «cocktail popolari» — refinement without pretension.
- From sustainability to mindfulness: the Green Star evolves into Michelin's «Mindful Voices».
- Regional cuisines go global: Californios — the world's first three-star Mexican restaurant.
- Gastronomy tourism & city branding: 50 Best week brings ~\$2M of spending to Lima.
- New gravity: Asia, the Middle East and Latin America lead the rankings.
- Hotel F&B; renaissance: hotel bars and dining rooms back on the world lists.

### CASES & FIELD MATERIAL

- The 50 Best Restaurants 2026 ceremony — Lima, 4 Nov 2026: the course follows it live.
- Tuju (São Paulo) — Art of Hospitality 2026: fewer guests, menus themed around climate.
- Gerbou (Dubai) — Prix Versailles 2025 for architecture; Emirati cuisine as fine dining.



#### OPEN-KITCHEN THEATRE

Chef's counters and tasting-menu dramaturgy as a managed business product.

### KEY QUESTION

If a venue opens today, which trends will still matter in 2030?

## MODULE 2 · WEEKS 4-5

# Venue Design & Atmosphere

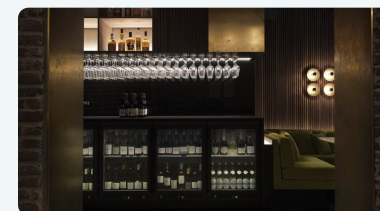
Concept, architecture, interiors, senses — atmosphere as an engineered product

### TOPICS

- Concept & narrative: the venue as a story guests retell.
- Space & ergonomics: layout, flow, comfort — a GreatList selection criterion.
- Light, acoustics, scent: the invisible layers of hospitality.
- Tableware & tactile design: weight, texture, temperature.
- Service choreography: rhythm of the evening, «invisible» service.
- Design awards as industry signal: Prix Versailles, Best Bar Design.
- Practice: atmosphere audit of Montreux venues against expert criteria.

### CASES & FIELD MATERIAL

- GreatList criteria: design & ergonomics; atmosphere «from scent to music»; full guest CJM.
- Himkok (Oslo) — Best Bar Design: a sustainable reimagining of a 200-year-old space.
- Hanu (Dubai) — Seoul aesthetics: charcoal grills, dark wood, bronze doors.



### ARCHITECTURE & LIGHTING

Lighting scenarios, tactile materials, and guest journey ergonomics.

### KEY QUESTION

Can atmosphere be measured — and can it be managed like a P&L; line?

## MODULE 3 · WEEKS 6-7

# Neurogastronomy & Guest Experience

Culinary science & gastrophysics: how the brain constructs flavour from all senses

### TOPICS

- Cooking as applied science: Maillard reactions, emulsions, fermentation & controlled testing.
- Gastrophysics basics: crossmodal correspondences (Spence, Oxford).
- Sound & taste: sonic seasoning; music changes perceived flavour.
- Colour, shape and weight of tableware; plating geometry.
- Menu psychology: naming, layout, price anchors, choice architecture.
- Memory, emotion & peak-end rule: designing «Proust moments».
- Sensory lab: a guided blind tasting with controlled variables.

### CASES & FIELD MATERIAL

- World Class 2025: The Singleton multisensory challenge — cocktail «Between Us» with a custom record sleeve for «That's Amore».
- Tuju: radical personalisation — reading glasses, children's drawing kit, menus of rain and wind.
- Bar Leone: simplicity as a sensory strategy — «cocktails for the people».



#### MULTISENSORY SERVE

Sound, aromatic smoke, and ceramic weight alter perceived flavour.

### KEY QUESTION

What does your venue taste like — before the first bite is served?

## MODULE 4 · WEEKS 8-9

# Technology & Automation

What should remain human — and what should be smart

### TOPICS

- Reservations & waitlist systems; dynamic pricing; revenue management.
- Kitchen & floor automation: robotics, KDS, inventory, waste control.
- Data & CRM: personalisation at the level of a regular guest.
- AI in creativity: concept art, menu R&D, content — and its limits.
- Delivery, dark kitchens and omnichannel models.
- Education tech: academies of spirits & wine (Sesto Senso).
- Ethics & future of work: humane workplaces in a high-pressure industry.

### CASES & FIELD MATERIAL

- World Class 2025: Don Julio 1942 challenge — a serve created from an original AI artwork.
- Felice Capasso: Sesto Senso Academy — bartender education as a business model.
- 50 Best «war room»: how rankings themselves use data, voting and media technology.



#### SMART F&B OPERATIONS

Reservation algorithms and KDS free up staff for human hospitality.

### KEY QUESTION

Where does technology amplify hospitality — and where does it kill it?

## MODULE 5 · WEEKS 10-12

# World's Leading Restaurants & Bars

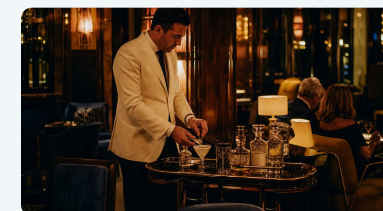
Deep dives into chef philosophies, institutions and venues setting the global standard

### TOPICS

- Chefs as authors & researchers: René Redzepi (Noma), Bottura, Humm, Martínez, Royer.
- MICHELIN anatomy: stars, Bib Gourmand, special awards, inspector method.
- The 50 Best Academy: who votes, how lists change markets.
- Bar scene: World's 50 Best Bars, hotel bars, speakeasies.
- World Class: 16 seasons, 450,000+ bartenders, «drink better, not more».
- GreatList geography: Moscow — Dubai — Doha — Bangkok — Shanghai.
- Final pitch: student concepts vs world benchmarks.

### CASES & FIELD MATERIAL

- Maido (Lima) — World's №1 Restaurant 2025; four Lima venues in the top 50.
- Bar Leone (Hong Kong) — World's Best Bar 2025, first Asian №1, two years after opening.
- Myojaku (Tokyo) — promoted to Three MICHELIN Stars in the 2026 guide.



### WORLD SERVICE BENCHMARKS

The martini trolley ritual and the renaissance of iconic hotel bars.

### KEY QUESTION

What do all №1 venues share — and can it be taught?

# The ranking ecosystem

Four institutions the course is built on — and how they differ

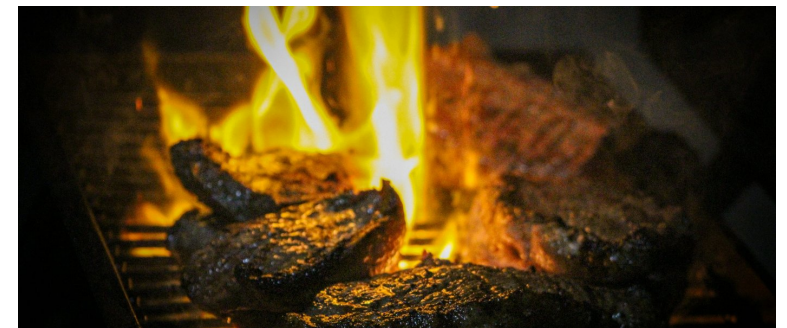
| Institution          | What it evaluates                 | Method                                                                                           | Status 2026                                                               |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| MICHELIN Guide       | Cuisine quality & consistency     | Anonymous inspectors; ★-★★★, Bib Gourmand, Green Star, special awards                            | City & country guides worldwide; 2026 reveals: Tokyo, California, Toronto |
| The 50 Best (The 50) | Restaurants & bars as experiences | Anonymous global academy; restaurants — 8 best experiences; bars — 600+ experts, 7 votes each    | Restaurant ceremony: Lima, 4 Nov 2026; Bars 2026: 51-100 already revealed |
| GreatList            | Best restaurants of global cities | 100+ experts, anonymous visits, self-paid bills; criteria: food, service CJM, design, atmosphere | Russia, UAE, Qatar, Thailand, China; Singapore & Seoul coming soon        |
| Diageo World Class   | Bartending craft & innovation     | National finals → global finals; 51 countries in 2025; expert jury of venue owners               | 16th season; winner 2025: Felice Capasso (Norway)                         |

# Case: The World's 50 Best Restaurants

Revealed in Turin, June 2025 — next chapter: Lima, 4 November 2026

| # | Restaurant       | City        | #  | Restaurant            | City         |
|---|------------------|-------------|----|-----------------------|--------------|
| 1 | Maido            | Lima        | 6  | Gaggan                | Bangkok      |
| 2 | Asador Etxebarri | Atxondo     | 7  | Sézanne               | Tokyo        |
| 3 | Quintonil        | Mexico City | 8  | Table by Bruno Verjus | Paris        |
| 4 | DiverXO          | Madrid      | 9  | Kjolle                | Lima         |
| 5 | Alchemist        | Copenhagen  | 10 | Don Julio             | Buenos Aires |

- Latin America sets the tone: №1 and №3, plus four Lima venues in the top 50.
- Voters receive no formal criteria — they name their eight best experiences of the year.
- 2026 Art of Hospitality Award: Tuju (São Paulo) — service as radical personalisation.
- Class use: students predict the 2026 list before the Lima ceremony, then score themselves.



**ASADOR ETXEBARRI · DON JULIO**

Open fire and radical product minimalism at the top of the world list.

# Case: The MICHELIN Guide

From tyre-maker's guide to the industry's most cited rating

## — The star anatomy.

★ — very good cuisine; ★★ — worth a detour; ★★★ — worth a special journey; plus Bib Gourmand and special awards (Service, Sommelier, Young Chef).

## — Tokyo 2026.

Myojaku promoted to Three Stars; 18 new stars; Service and Sommelier awards — the world's deepest starred scene.

## — California 2026.

Californios becomes the first Mexican restaurant in the world with Three Stars.

## — Sustainability & geopolitics.

Green Star transitions into «Mindful Voices». The Moscow chapter (debut 2021, suspended 2022) — a case study in rankings and geopolitics.



### MICHELIN 2026 · CALIFORNIOS & MYOJAKU

Bespoke ceramic tableware, technical mastery, and regional identity at ★★★ level.

### FIVE CRITERIA OF MICHELIN INSPECTORS

1. Quality of ingredients · 2. Mastery of cooking technique · 3. Harmony and clarity of flavours · 4. Personality of the chef in the dish · 5. Consistency across visits.

# Case: The World's 50 Best Bars 2025

Ceremony in Hong Kong: for the first time, №1 goes to Asia

| # | Bar                 | City        | #  | Bar            | City         |
|---|---------------------|-------------|----|----------------|--------------|
| 1 | Bar Leone           | Hong Kong   | 6  | Connaught Bar  | London       |
| 2 | Handshake Speakeasy | Mexico City | 7  | Moebius Milano | Milan        |
| 3 | Sips                | Barcelona   | 8  | Line           | Athens       |
| 4 | Paradiso            | Barcelona   | 9  | Jigger & Pony  | Singapore    |
| 5 | Tayēr + Elementary  | London      | 10 | Tres Monos     | Buenos Aires |

- Bar Leone: №1 only two years after opening — «cocktail popolari», classics without pretension.
- Best Bar Design: Himkok (Oslo) — sustainable reimagining of a 200-year-old space.
- Sustainable Bar: The Cambridge Public House (Paris); first-ever Best Bar in Africa (Hero Bar, Nairobi) and Middle East (Mimi Kakushi, Dubai).



## BAR LEONE · COCKTAIL POPOLARI

A return to warm neighbourhood hospitality and unpretentious classic cocktails.

# Cases: Diageo World Class & GreatList

People and expertise behind the headlines

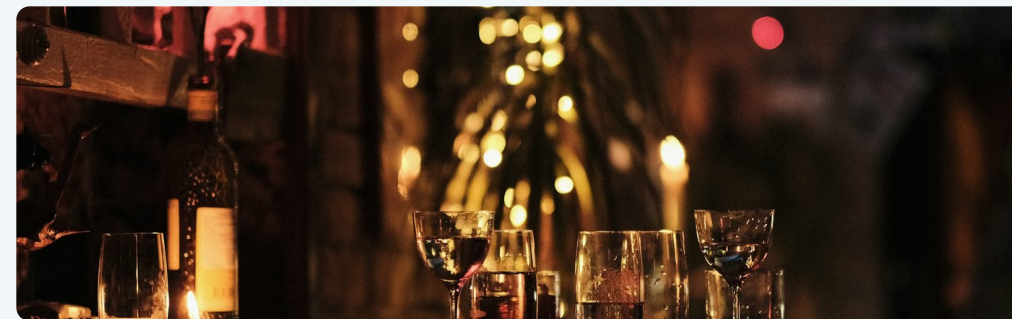
## DIAGEO WORLD CLASS 2025 · TORONTO

- Winner: Felice Capasso (Norway) — Nedre Løkka Cocktailbar, Oslo; founder of Sesto Senso Academy.
- Challenges: reimagined classics with Johnnie Walker Black Label; Don Julio 1942 serve inspired by AI artwork; multisensory Singleton serve.
- Jury: Eric Van Beek (Handshake Speakeasy), Monica Berg (Tayēr + Elementary), Ago Perrone (Connaught Bar).



## GREATLIST · INTERNATIONAL RESTAURANT GUIDE

- Founded 2022; 100+ experts; anonymous visits, self-paid bills, repeat visits at different hours.
- Criteria: food & chef imagination; service across the full CJM; design & ergonomics; atmosphere — from scent to music.
- Geography: Russia, Dubai, Doha, Bangkok, Hong Kong, Shanghai (+ Singapore & Seoul soon); GreatList Sessions guest dinners.



# Teaching methodology

Every session: 45' lecture · 75' cases · 60' practice — plus the through-project «My Venue»

1

## Case method on live venues

Maido, Bar Leone, Tuju, Himkok, Hanu — dissected as business systems: concept, economics, guest journey.

2

## Sensory labs

Guided tastings testing neurogastronomy hypotheses: light, sound, weight, naming.

3

## Atmosphere audits

Field teams evaluate Montreux & Riviera venues against GreatList-style criteria and present findings.

4

## Guest speakers

Chefs, bartenders, restaurateurs and ranking experts — live or online, from the course's industry network.

5

## Rankings war room

Real-time analysis of new lists — including the Lima ceremony of 4 November 2026.

6

## 5-minute reflection & peer review

5 minutes of silent individual notes before plenary debate; every «My Venue» page is peer-reviewed in pairs.

# Practical core: «My Venue»

Every student builds their own bar or restaurant — from idea to «open & operate»

## WEEK 1 · ASSIGNMENT 0

Each student presents their favourite bar or restaurant (5 min) through the course's four lenses — trends, design & atmosphere, senses, rankings. One change they would make as the owner.

| Wk | Milestone of the student's own concept              | Wk | Milestone of the student's own concept                                             |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2  | Concept & USP; three world benchmarks               | 8  | Operations & technology: service model, stack, human line                          |
| 3  | Trend memo: which trends the concept rides          | 9  | AI & ethics page of the concept                                                    |
| 4  | Design & narrative: interior «three scenes», zoning | 10 | Marketing I: guest shifts & residencies, alcohol-brand partnerships, 90-day launch |
| 5  | Atmosphere spec + audit of a real Montreux venue    | 11 | Marketing II: 3-year roadmap to a chosen guide or list                             |
| 6  | Three signature serves built on sensory effects     | 12 | Final pitch «Open & Operate» before an expert panel                                |
| 7  | Menu architecture, pricing, an A/B test             |    |                                                                                    |

Format: one A4 page or two slides added every week; peer-reviewed in pairs. The folder of 11 pages becomes the final concept deck.

# Assessment

Continuous, practice-based, industry-style

| Component                    | Weight | What students do                                                              |
|------------------------------|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Assignment 0 & participation | 10%    | Week-1 «favourite venue» talk; case discussions, war-room sessions            |
| Field Notes (weekly)         | 15%    | One-page weekly reviews: a venue visit, a ranking change, an industry article |
| «My Venue» weekly milestones | 35%    | Eleven weekly pages of the student's own concept; peer-reviewed               |
| Final pitch «Open & Operate» | 40%    | Full concept deck defended before an expert panel                             |

Grading follows HIM regulations. Late work policy and AI-use disclosure follow the institute's academic integrity rules.

# Final pitch: «Open & Operate»

Each student's own venue: restaurant, bar, hotel F&B, pop-up — ready to open

## 01

### USP & STORY

One-sentence USP, audience, price point — why the world should care.

## 02

### DESIGN & ATMOSPHERE

Concept board: interior, light, sound, scent, tableware — managed senses.

## 03

### MENU, BEVERAGE & OPERATIONS

Neurogastronomy-backed serves; service model, tech stack, unit-economics sketch.

## 04

### MARKETING ENGINE

Guest shifts & chef residencies (GreatList Sessions model); alcohol-brand partnerships (World Class formats); 90-day launch plan.

## 05

### ROADMAP TO RECOGNITION

One target guide or list — and a 3-year plan to earn it.

The panel includes invited industry professionals. The strongest concept is recommended for HIM student hospitality competitions and accelerator formats.

# Fit with HIM & resources

The course extends the institute's ecosystem, not duplicates it

## INTEGRATION WITH HIM

- Swiss hospitality tradition meets the global scene — the same duality HIM stands for.
- Montreux Jazz Festival field module: festival F&B; operations (HIM's long-standing partner).
- Connects to existing curriculum: marketing, revenue management, innovation, luxury business.
- Career bridge: students learn what world-class venues look for in managers and interns.

## COURSE RESOURCES

- Live data: MICHELIN Guide reveals, The 50 rankings & stories, GreatList encyclopedia, World Class materials.
- Reading list: Guidara «Unreasonable Hospitality»; Meyer «Setting the Table»; Spence «Gastrophysics»; Pine & Gilmore «The Experience Economy».
- Video: The 50 films and Talks; ceremony livestreams.
- Guest network: alumni and industry contacts of the course author.

# Week-by-week plan

12 sessions · each lesson has its own full prose & photo presentation deck

| Wk | Session                                                                                                        |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | Lesson 1. Introduction. Anatomy of contemporary HoReCa. Rankings as industry infrastructure.                   |
| 2  | Lesson 2. Macro-trends I: experience economy 2.0, anti-luxury, casualization of fine dining.                   |
| 3  | Lesson 3. Macro-trends II: mindfulness, regional cuisines go global, gastro-tourism & hotel F&B.;              |
| 4  | Lesson 4. Venue design: concept as narrative, architecture, interior, ergonomics (Prix Versailles; GreatList). |
| 5  | Lesson 5. Engineering atmosphere: light, sound, scent, tableware, service choreography. Field audit.           |
| 6  | Lesson 6. Culinary science & neurogastronomy I: flavour chemistry, gastrophysics, sensory lab.                 |
| 7  | Lesson 7. Neurogastronomy II: menu psychology, pricing, peak-end design, World Class multisensory case.        |
| 8  | Lesson 8. Technology I: reservations, revenue management, kitchen & floor automation, CRM.                     |
| 9  | Lesson 9. Technology II: AI in creativity and operations, Sesto Senso Academy, ethics & future of work.        |
| 10 | Lesson 10. World restaurants: chef philosophies (Noma et al.), MICHELIN & 50 Best deep dive.                   |
| 11 | Lesson 11. World bars: 50 Best Bars, World Class, hotel bars; Moscow-Dubai-Doha via GreatList.                 |
| 12 | Lesson 12. Final Pitch Day «Open & Operate»: defending student concepts before an expert panel.                |



C O N T E M P O R A R Y   H O R E C A   S C E N E

# Bring the world's best hospitality into the classroom.

**Egor Tarasenko**

Master in Business Management · Hotel Institute Montreux Alumnus

Montreux · 2026

Sources: MICHELIN Guide · The 50 Best · GreatList · Diageo World Class

